TABLE 3.2. Information withholding (placebo test)

	Missingness of scientific variables			
	Raw state-reported			Estimated or imputed
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Populism	0.084***	0.065***	0.058***	0.045
	(0.020)	(0.016)	(0.018)	(0.028)
Polity2		−0.008***	−0.005***	−0.010***
		(0.002)	(0.002)	(0.002)
Right-wing			0.0002	0.016
			(0.008)	(0.015)
GDP per capita (ln)			0.001	0.004
			(0.022)	(0.046)
IMF program			−0.0004	0.005
			(0.008)	(0.015)
Observations	7,656	4,614	4,026	4,026

Note: All models include country and year fixed effects and standard errors clustered by country. Independent variables are lagged by one year. Estimated via OLS. DV is standardized.
*p <0.1; **p <0.05; ***p <0.01

The results, summarized in table 3.2, show that populist leadership is associated with a statistically significant increase in missing scientific data. Specifically, populists in power contribute to a 1.75 percent increase in missing scientific indicators annually, translating to missing data for three to four additional indicators on average. The effect is concentrated in raw, state-provided data, as shown in the placebo tests, which reveal no significant relationship for data sourced from nonstate providers like IOs or NGOs.

To further explore the quality of data provided by populist governments, we examine greenhouse gas emissions reporting under the UNFCCC (see table 3.3). Using data from Annex I countries (industrialized and transition economies), we calculate the absolute difference between emissions figures